# Where You Are: Agreeing on What Matters, and the Steps That Follow

All nine steps of the Family Care Roadmap, and where your family is standing.

With a decision close and the family pulling in different directions, it can feel as if the family has to settle everything at once. This is one step, and it's the first of nine.

Below are all nine steps with yours marked, then what this step produces and who is involved next.

## Phase 1 · Care Assessment

Understand the person, the family, and the situation.

1 **Discover** Current Situation → Concerns & Challenges → Goals & Priorities
You finish with: Family Discovery Summary

**You are here.** This is the third topic of the Discover step: what matters. The family's part is to write down what your loved one has said they want, what each relative is worried about and hoping for, where you agree, where you don't, and the questions still open. You don't have to agree on everything to finish it.

2 **Assess** Health & Function → Safety & Support → Lifestyle & Preferences
You finish with: Personal Care Assessment Summary

3 **Define Needs** Needs & Risks → Care Requirements → Priorities & Recommendations
You finish with: Care Needs Profile and Immediate Action Roadmap

## Phase 2 · Care Planning

Determine what good care should look like and prepare to put it in place.

4 **Explore Options** Care Setting → Provider/Facility Fit → Selection & Decision
You finish with: Care Options Comparison and Decision Record

5 **Build the Plan** Health & Personal Care → Daily Life & Quality of Life → Monitoring & Response
You finish with: Personal Care Proposal, Good Day Plan, and Monitoring Plan

6 **Prepare the Transition** Preparation → Move & Admission → Continuity of Care
You finish with: Transition Preparation Pack and Confirmed Handoff Log

## Phase 3 · Care Management

Coordinate the plan, review what happens, and prepare the family to take the lead.

7 **Coordinate** People & Responsibilities → Communication & Handoffs → Care-Plan Alignment
You finish with: Care Team Plan and Care-Plan Alignment Record

8 **Monitor** Monitor → Identify & Escalate → Review & Adjust
You finish with: Care Review Dashboard and Concern/Change Logs

9 **Hand Off** Educate → Empower → Support

You finish with: Family Care Management Playbook and Handoff/Support Plan

## What this step produces

A page that keeps your loved one's wishes separate from the family's preferences, and records where the family agrees, what is still unresolved and who will clarify each open question. It is the family's own account, organized. It isn't an assessment and it isn't a decision.

Together with the two earlier topics of this step, where things stand today and what has become hard, it makes up the Family Discovery Summary. Agreeing on the criteria for comparing options is the last part of this topic, and it isn't done on this page.

## What happens next

This topic closes the Discover step. The next step, Assess, looks at your loved one's health and function, their safety and support, and their lifestyle and preferences. Define Needs then states what care has to cover. Options are compared at step four, with all of that in hand.

What you write here isn't final. The National Institute on Aging notes that caregiving decisions may need to be revised over time, as the person's needs and family members' availability change, and the Family Caregiver Alliance reminds families that a meeting is not a one-time event. A disagreement you've written down can travel with you to the next step. [1] [2]

## Who is involved, by role

- Your loved one: what they want, in their own words.
- You and the relatives involved: your worries, your hopes, and what each of you can realistically do.
- Their clinicians (doctor, nurse, therapist): the questions about health and ability that nobody in the family can answer.
- A neutral person from outside the family, if you want one: the Family Caregiver Alliance says this often helps when a family is divided on a big issue, and names social workers, ministers, private case managers, physicians and hospital discharge planners as people who can do it or refer you.
- Your care consultant: asks your loved one what is important to them, keeps their wishes separate from the family's, and helps the family see where it agrees, where it doesn't, and what each of you can realistically contribute.

**What this page doesn't promise**

How long a step takes, who will be available to help, or how the decision comes out. Every family moves along the road at its own pace.

### Ready for the next step?

You know where this step sits, what it produces and who is involved next. The care interview is how you carry it forward: it takes you through your loved one's situation area by area, so what the family wants sits beside what is going on, and turns your answers into a Family Care Profile you can bring to any care conversation.

**Create Your Free Family Care Profile ›**

#### WHERE THIS COMES FROM

The nine steps are the Family Care Roadmap's own. The points about revising decisions, meeting more than once and inviting a neutral facilitator come from the sources below.


1. National Institute on Aging, Sharing Caregiving Responsibilities
2. Family Caregiver Alliance, Holding a Family Meeting